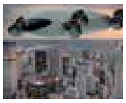
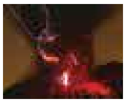


Startup building drone bus
Kelekona, is a startup that is working on a 40-seat drone bus.
http://dgit.in/Jul21-47



Electric bursts from volcanoes.
Mysterious electrical signals could help warn aviators of impending volcanic ash plumes.
http://dgit.in/Jul21-48

prises, companies deploying new sensors, systems integrators, distributors, Governments and OEMs."

Rajeev Suri, Inmarsat Chief Executive Officer said, "The most effective IoT solutions require a truly resilient and flexible network that can scale as demand grows. Inmarsat's industry-leading L-band network provides a unique capability for enabling the billions of connected IoT devices in India and across the world that are being deployed at an extraordinary speed. We are delighted to work with Skylo to provide the IoT fabric that matches their ambition."

Following the announcement, we spoke to Angira Agrawal, COO of Skylo about the need for their disruptive solution here, "Increasingly the world is going to be dependent on IoT, and there are going to be billions and billions of devices that are going to be deployed. Most terrestrial mobile networks that operate today are designed for needs that people have, and not designed to cater to the needs that IoT devices have. Specifically the need is low throughput of data, and ubiquitous connectivity. Typically, IoT devices are attached onto assets, whether they are fixed or mobile, which operate in any part of the world, and are not necessarily restricted to being where people are. In fact, IoT is increasingly replacing the person who has to go and measure a particular data point. The appetite that Indians have for leveraging technologies to solve business problems is fairly high."

"The parallels with climate change are clear, and as a space community we should learn the lessons that proactive and early management is required to ensure that we don't wait until the damage is done."

MARK DICKINSON
Vice President Space Segment, Inmarsat

For example, when it comes to transporting vaccines, the solution can ensure that all the vaccines are stored at the right temperatures, were not tampered with on the route, and security agencies can track the vehicle even as it moves through remote areas, along with geofencing capabilities. There have been allegations of truck doors being opened on the way, and the vaccine doses replaced with salt water, and Skylo's solution promises to prevent any such potential incidents.

Angira tells us, "What the Health Ministry wants is that they want to know at any point of time, where the vaccine is and when it is going to reach the destination, because at that location there need to be doctors available so that the vaccines can be administered quickly to the citizens of India. But, they also need to know if the vaccines have been transported at the right temperature, and there is no pilferage on the way. We need to ensure that all these elements are in place. From an end user viewpoint, that is something that is revolutionary because when a truck carrying vaccines goes to a remote part of the country, on the way, multiple times, there will be no mobile connectivity. That is when there could be untoward incidents, or miscreants could try to fool around with the way the vaccines are being transported." Angira continues, "another use case that I can talk about is the recent cyclone, Taukte.

This time the government had a lot more time to communicate because the cyclone buildup was visible. But sometimes, cyclones come very fast, and the fishermen would take three to four days to get back to shore. Typically, they (government personnel) use radio frequencies to communicate with the fishermen saying there is a cyclone building up, please come back to a safe harbours on land. In the case of Skylo, the fishermen could be reached even if they are in deep sea, completely out of mobile network or VHF network range. The fishermen could be sent a message on the boat, where the Skylo Hub is attached, and they new what the situation was, and they could take the appropriate action to come back to shore. It was direct communication to them rather than dependent on something like if you spot a boat, please let that boat know to head back to sure. Rather than hit and miss, it was very clearly targeted."

Angira then goes on to explain how the solution helps with logistics

Credit: Skylo

The Skylo Hub